

4.5 News And Updates

One of the major gains of the Internet has been the fast dispensing of information. The direct fallout of this connected environment has been on news. Because of the nature of the connected world, there is always an audience for news at any given point in time.

What started off as an appendage to the existing media has gone on to become as big, or in some areas, larger than conventional media. It is very common to find people getting their daily news updates from the Net, and today's hectic work schedules has only increased this.

Media houses and news agencies around the world have woken up to this reality and have effectively tailored their layout and presentation styles to meet the Netizens' requirements. Sites such as Salon.com and Slate.com provide exemplary coverage of current affairs; they also have columnists writing features on a variety of subjects. One major advantage of being an online publication is that you can get a wider range of people to contribute, and thus readers are exposed to a variety of opinions.



Prompt News Updates Are One Of The Biggest Gains From The Internet

A lot of sites focusing only on news have come up in the last couple of years. A few such as Reuters.com and NDTV.com also provide streaming video content.

New technologies such as RSS and Podcasting are also revolutionising the way we receive our news updates. Using feed readers (as explained in the June 2005 issue of *Digit*), we can get a regular